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COMPLETE TRAINING PROGRAM

For Muscle Building & Strength

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Introduction

Welcome to my Push-Pull-Legs training program.
This program is the exact system that has helped me build strength, muscle, and consistency in the gym over the past five years. I didn't create this program based on theories or trends. I built it through real experience, trial and error, and refining what truly works.

It balances intensity, volume and recovery to ensure steady progress without burnout. My aim is to offer a training plan that's both effective and sustainable, helping you achieve long-term results while minimizing the risk of injury.

WHO THIS PROGRAM IS FOR?

This program is for anyone looking to build muscle, regardless of experience level or training goals. Whether you're:

- Just starting out and need a structured plan to follow
- An experienced lifter looking for an effective routine
- Training alone, like I usually do, and want a program that keeps you accountable
- Seeking a simple yet powerful approach that eliminates guesswork and maximizes results

The training approach remains the same whether you're bulking, cutting, or maintaining. The difference comes down to your diet and recovery, your training intensity and effort should always stay consistent.

So, let's get started and build a physique that's strong, functional, and aesthetic!

Training Principles

Train to (or Close to) Failure

I push every working set to the point where I physically can't do another clean rep, even if I try. This level of effort is what's driven real progress in my training over the years. Whether you're a beginner or experienced, getting close to failure is what actually signals the body to grow.

Progressive Overload is the Goal

Getting stronger over time is the backbone of this program. Here's how you keep progressing:

- Add more weight when you can
- Do more reps with the same weight
- Use better form with the same load
- I used to track all my lifts in my phone — it kept me accountable and showed me what to beat next session. Don't just train hard — train to improve.

Why I Use Machines (and Why It Works)

I train solo most of the time, so machines let me safely hit failure without a spotter. They also reduce injury risk while keeping tension on the target muscle.
If your gym doesn't have certain machines or you prefer free weights, no worries, I've included effective alternatives that I personally use from time to time.

Warming Up Properly

Before each movement:

- Do 1-2 lighter sets to groove the movement
- Gradually increase weight with a few controlled reps
- Once you're warm, you're ready to hit your working sets. These warm-up sets don't count toward your actual sets — they're just to prep your body and joints.

Smart Rest Times

- Big compound lifts (presses, squats, rows): 3–5 minutes
- Smaller isolation work (curls, raises, pushdowns): 2–3 minutes
- Resting long enough helps you lift more and get more out of each set. Your muscles need time to recover between sets, especially after hard sets taken close to failure. If you cut rest too short, your performance drops — meaning fewer reps, less weight, and less stimulus for growth. Don't rush it. Give your body what it needs, then attack the next set with full effort.

Nutrition Basics

My approach on nutrition:

- **Protein**: Aim for about 1g of protein per pound of body weight. Protein helps with muscle repair, growth, and recovery. Great sources include chicken, lean beef, eggs, fish, greek yogurt, and protein shakes if needed.

- **Fats**: Essential for hormone production, brain function, and overall health. Fat doesn't make you fat—overeating calories does. Men should aim for 50-80g per day, and women should aim for 45-70g per day. Good fat sources include avocados, nuts, olive oil, fatty fish, and whole eggs. Be mindful of portions since fats are calorie-dense (9 calories per gram).

- **Carbs**: While not essential for survival, carbs are the body's main energy source. They also help replenish muscle glycogen. Great carb sources include rice, oats, potatoes, pasta, fruits, and honey.

- **Calories**:
  - Building Muscle: Eat around 300-500 extra calories per day to fuel growth without gaining excess fat.
  - Losing Fat: Eat 300-800 calories below maintenance to lose fat while preserving muscle.
  - Weigh yourself consistently to stay on track and adjust as needed.

At the end of the day, calories in vs. calories out is what matters most. You could technically lose fat eating junk food if you're in a calorie deficit, or gain fat eating clean & healthy if you're overeating. Consistency is key!

Note: This program focuses on training, so it doesn't cover nutrition in full detail. For a complete nutrition guide, check out my Nutrition eBook.

Training Approach

This is a Push / Pull / Legs (PPL) split, repeated across the week:
3 days on → 1 day off — then repeat.

Over an 8-day cycle, you'll hit each muscle group twice, providing the right balance of training and recovery.

🔹 Push Day
Chest, Shoulders, Triceps
🔹 Pull Day
Back, Biceps
🔹 Leg Day
Quads, Glutes, Hamstrings, Calves
🔹 Rest Day
Take a full rest day after 3 training days to recover and recharge.

Rest Days Matter
Rest is crucial for recovery and growth. After every 3 training days, take a full rest day. Use it for sleep, active recovery, and proper nutrition. Don't rush back to the gym; let your body recover so you can hit it hard when you train again. The only time I find myself in the gym on a rest day is to do light cardio, especially when I'm cutting down.

How I Handle Deloads
I don't schedule deloads. If I feel run down or my performance drops, I take 3-4 full days off from the gym. This mental and physical reset helps me come back stronger, ready to push hard again.

Final Tips
- Stick to the structure — consistency matters more than perfection.
- Push hard — challenge yourself on every set.
- Rest well — prioritize sleep, food, and recovery.
- Track progress — ensure you're improving over time.
- Stay patient — muscle growth takes time.

If you show up, push yourself, and stay consistent, the results will follow. Let's get to work.

Push Day

Exercise	Sets	Rep Range	Rest	Video Demo Link
Incline Chest Press Machine	3	6-12	3-5 min	
Flat Chest Press Machine	2	6-12	3-5 min	
Machine Chest Flyes	2	8-12	2-3 min	
Shoulder Press Machine	2	6-12	3-5 min	
Dumbbell Lateral Raises	4	8-15	2-3 min	
Tricep Rope Pushdown	3	8-15	2-3 min	
Weighted Dips	3	8-12	3-5 min	

Alternatives I Sometimes Use:

- Smith Incline Bench Press (for Incline Chest Press Machine)
- Flat Bench Press (for Flat Chest Press Machine)
- Cable Flyes (for Machine Flyes)
- Seated Dumbbell Shoulder Press (for Machine Shoulder Press)
- Lateral Raise Machine (for Dumbbell Lateral Raises)
- Flat Bar Tricep Pushdown (for Rope Pushdown)

Pull Day

Exercise	Sets	Rep Range	Rest	Video Demo Link
Plate-Loaded Row Machine	3	6-12	3-5 min	
Chest-Supported T-Bar Row	3	6-12	3-5 min	
Cable Lat Pulldown	3	8-12	3-5 min	
Dumbbell Bicep Curls	3	8-12	2-3 min	
Bicep Curls Machine	3	8-12	2-3 min	
Rear Delt Machine (Sometimes)	2	10-15	2-3 min	

Alternatives I Sometimes Use:

Bent Over Barbell Rows (for Plated-Loaded Row)

Single Arm Dumbbell Rows (for T-Bar Row)

Weighted Pull Ups (for any Exercise)

Flat Bar Cable Curls (for any Bicep Exercise)

Leg Day

Exercise	Sets	Rep Range	Rest	Video Demo Link
Smith Machine Squats	2	6-10	3-5 min	
Leg Extension Machine	3	8-15	3-5 min	
Lying Leg Curl Machine	3	8-15	2-4 min	
Adductor Machine	3	8-16	2-3 min	
Standing Calf Raises	3	8-16	2-3 min	
Seated Calf Raises	3	8-16	2-3 min	

Alternatives I Sometimes Use:

Leg Press (for Smith Machine Squats)

Romanian Deadlifts (for Lying Leg Curl Machine)

Leg Press Calf Raises (for either Calf exercise)

Progression

Progressive overload is the foundation of this program. If you're not getting stronger, improving your performance, or making changes to your physique over time then something needs to be adjusted.

How I Add Weight
If I can hit the upper end of the rep range (like 12 reps in a 6–12 range) for all sets with good form, I'll bump the weight up next session.
Even adding 1–2.5 kg might not seem like much, but those small jumps lead to big changes over time.

Other Ways I Measure Progress
It's not just about lifting heavier:

- Getting more reps with the same weight
- Using better form or slower, more controlled reps
- Improving mind-muscle connection
- Reducing rest times slightly (as long as performance stays strong)
- Doing more total volume over the session

All of these are signs that you're getting better, even if the scale or mirror isn't showing drastic changes right away.

Tracking My Workouts
I use the notes app on my phone to record:

- What weight I lifted
- How many reps I got on each set
- How the set felt (easy, tough, grindy, etc.)

This gives me a clear roadmap of where I'm improving and what needs work.

Seeing Results
Progress isn't just about numbers in the gym:

- Take progress photos every few weeks — same lighting, same poses
- Record videos of your lifts — you'll see improvements in strength, control, and form
- Pay attention to how your clothes fit and how you feel day to day

The changes might feel slow, but when you look back after a month or two, you'll notice how far you've come. Trust the process and give it time.

Extras

Consistency is the Secret to Progress
Every day, you're getting one step closer to your goals. It's not about perfection, but about showing up and giving your best effort. Some days will feel easier than others, but stay the course — progress comes to those who put in the work day in and day out.

Supplements
I don't rely on supplements for muscle growth, but I do use a few for overall health. I take 5g of unflavored creatine monohydrate daily, whey protein when I can't hit my protein goal through food, and vitamins like fish oil and omega-3s. These won't directly build muscle, but they support performance, recovery, and general health. Focus on training and nutrition first; supplements are just an addition.

Program Flexibility
This program is based on what's worked for me, but feel free to adjust it to fit your needs. Swap exercises based on the equipment you have or what feels best for your body. The key is consistency and progression, so adapt the program in a way that helps you stay on track and continue pushing yourself.

Fuel Your Success
Your body needs fuel to build muscle and recover. Keep your nutrition on point and prioritize rest. Sleep, hydration, and balanced meals are just as important as your gym sessions.

Keep Pushing, Even When It's Tough
There will be days when you feel like giving up, but remember why you started. Those tough days are the ones that shape you. Push through, and when you feel like you can't, remember: you're capable of more than you think.

You've got this — stay consistent, trust the process, and give it your all.
Good luck!

If you have any questions, need support or want to share your progress, feel free to reach out to me on Instagram **@harunrfit** or via email at **admin@harunfit.com**